

Valentin Nikolaev

Senior Backend Engineer — Go & PHP

Fiumicino / Rome, Italy +39 351 370 1194 | valeinikolaev@gmail.com [LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#)

Summary

Backend engineer with 15+ years of experience building and improving production systems, with deep PHP expertise and an increasing focus on Go. Recent work includes owning Go-based APIs and automation services, designing event-driven pipelines, and improving reliability under production load. Experienced with PHP-to-modern-backend evolution, AWS, Kubernetes, messaging, CI/CD, performance optimization, security-conscious engineering, and close collaboration with product and technical stakeholders. Background includes digital health, SaaS, e-commerce, fintech-related systems, and high-volume communications.

Skills

- Go
- PHP
- Laravel
- Symfony
- REST APIs
- AWS
- Kubernetes
- Helm
- RabbitMQ
- MySQL
- PostgreSQL
- Microservices
- Event-driven architecture
- CI/CD
- Production performance and reliability

Experience

Simple App — Software Developer

November 2023 – March 2026

- Designed and owned a Go-based support automation platform connecting Zendesk, Intercom, and internal services through a scalable backend and unified API orchestration layer.
- Automated or deflected up to 30% of inbound tickets by integrating auto-triage workflows into production support operations.

- Migrated business-critical flows from Zendesk to Intercom's real-time engine, reducing first-response time by 35% and improving resolution rate by 28%.
- Built resilient message-delivery pipelines with retries, fallback logic, and monitoring, reducing incident-related disruptions by more than 50%.
- Supported tens of thousands of monthly user interactions while collaborating with Support Operations, Product, and AI teams.

CRURATED — Software Developer

August 2024 – January 2026 | Rome, Italy

- Architected an event-driven analytics platform using queues and AWS EventBridge, increasing throughput to the data lake by more than 10x.
- Defined a versioned event schema and modular routing design that reduced implementation time for new analytics streams from several days to under four hours.
- Built multi-destination delivery flows for webhooks and S3 with backpressure handling, automatic retries, and observability.
- Maintained event-delivery reliability above 99.9% and worked with product and engineering leadership on end-to-end visibility of critical flows.

airSlate — Senior Software Developer / Technical Lead

February 2021 – August 2023 | Kyiv, Ukraine

- Migrated managed services from ECS to Kubernetes and prepared Helm, GitHub Actions, and ArgoCD delivery workflows, cutting infrastructure costs by 30% and improving performance by more than 20%.
- Reduced database workload and removed API and query bottlenecks, lowering average API response time by 30% and improving stability during peak traffic.
- Developed shared Laravel/Symfony backend components and implemented CI/CD pipelines that accelerated feature delivery.
- Troubleshoot production incidents through logs, monitoring, and SRE dashboards and delivered operational fixes and optimizations.
- Coordinated planning and delivery across the development lifecycle and directly supported team execution and technical hiring.

Hypr — Technical Lead

November 2019 – January 2021

- Led backend development for a PHP- and Go-based digital platform and helped move it from prototype to closed beta in under six months.
- Defined the technology roadmap with the CTO and contributed to microservice, serverless, CI/CD, reliability, and serviceability decisions.
- Worked directly with business and technical stakeholders to translate product goals into architecture and delivery plans.
- Managed ten developers and supported technical decisions across product development.

Sixt — Senior Software Developer

December 2018 – November 2019 | Kyiv, Ukraine

- Developed backend microservices supporting EU GDPR requirements and maintained code in compliance with PCI DSS controls.
- Participated in technical viability assessments covering functional, performance, and operational criteria.
- Conducted security assessments and vulnerability reviews to identify and address implementation risks.

PDFfiller.com — Technical Lead

October 2016 – December 2018 | Kyiv, Ukraine

- Led five backend engineers developing a high-volume transactional email service.
- Scaled the platform to approximately 50 million emails per month and handled BFCM periods with more than 10x normal traffic.
- Made architecture and reliability decisions across PHP services, MySQL, RabbitMQ, AWS, and REST integrations.
- Coached engineers and introduced delivery and performance metrics to improve team execution.

Education

MSc in Computer Science National Technical University "Kharkiv Polytechnic Institute", Ukraine | 2003 – 2008

Languages

- Ukrainian — Native
- Russian — Native or bilingual
- English — Upper-intermediate